was ruled out by his dislike for cutting up animals. Botany, however, proved to be a happy choice.

Deshmukh attended lectures in the mornings and practicals in the afternoons. He studied Geography for a diploma and also studied for Part I of the Bar examination. Whatever spare time he had, he used to read up some of the additional subjects he would need for the ICS examination which he planned to take in August 1918. Deshmukh having passed the Bombay University's Intermediate examination in first class with a classical language was given a year's exemption under the extant rules. The second year's examination in Natural Sciences, the Mays, took place in May 1916 and he passed in the first class and was awarded a college scholarship of £40 a year.

The next year in the Tripos Part I examination, Deshmukh's results were just as good. He not only passed in the first class but also won the Frank Smart Prize for standing first in Botany. In those days, Cambridge did not publish marks, and Deshmukh curious to know how he had fared in Chemistry and Geology, queried his tutors to that effect. While they did not reveal his marks, he learnt that he had topped in Chemistry and Geology as well and each of his professors expressed the hope that he would take their subject for Part II of the Tripos. At Cambridge, Deshmukh befriended Birbal Sahni and C.K. Desai (a nephew of Vithalbhai and Vallabhbhai Patel), John Matthai, who was at Oxford, and the mathematical genius Ramanujan, who was then at Trinity College. The Union remained closed as a debating forum due to the war, but the Indian Majlis was an active body of which Deshmukh rose to become President.

With the ICS examination looming large on the horizon, Deshmukh left Cambridge to continue his studies for the ICS examination in London. He devoted his time to other subjects including English, Sanskrit, and Law. As a standby in case he failed to clear the ICS examination, Deshmukh joined the Inner Temple and passed Part I in the first class. The ICS examination was held in August 1918, covering ten subjects—nineteen papers and four practicals. There was no *viva voce* in those days. When the results were declared, Deshmukh found that he had topped the list of candidates. S.K. Sinha, son of the famous Lord Sinha, was in second place. Deshmukh scored 3,520 out of 5900 marks, after 60 marks had been deducted for bad handwriting. In later years, he was able to compare his performance with